

Freshman Alumni Bot

A Guide for Group Leaders

How to switch on the bot in your group, walk members through onboarding, and handle the people who fall outside the usual checks.

VERSION

1.0

UPDATED

1 August 2026

BOT

@freshmanalumni_bot

1 How to Set It Up

Three steps, about a minute.

Step 1 Open the group, add the bot as a member: Members → Add Member → @freshmanalumni_bot.

Step 2 Promote it to Administrator, with the Pin Messages right turned on. It needs both to post and pin the announcement.

Step 3 Send /gate_announce in the group. This posts and pins the join announcement, and switches the group on.

Step 3 is for department leads

Not a lead? Do steps 1 and 2, then ask one to run /gate_announce for you, it takes a second. For anyone else, the command just stays silent, no error.

Switching a group on is what counts it toward Alumni group membership, which is why it's dep-lead only. Each group switches on separately, so you choose which ones take part, and can add more anytime. Repeat all three steps per group.

Someone Outside Every Group

Guest speakers and graduates who left every chat years ago won't show up in the checks above. Message **Samandar (@gapyearingdoesntsuck)** for a one-time code, looks like **FA-K7M2Q-XR94T**. They paste it into the bot in a private chat and complete the same onboarding, skipping the group check. Each code works **once** and expires in **30 days**.

2 Why Administrator Matters

Administrator rights aren't a formality: **the bot is inert without them**. Telegram only reveals who joins a group to an Administrator, and pinning needs the **Pin Messages** right specifically. Add the bot as an ordinary member and nothing happens at all: no enrollment, no announcement, no error. That's the most common reason a group looks broken.

Promotion alone doesn't switch anything on either, since anyone can promote a bot in a group they just made. The **/gate_announce** command is the step that actually counts.

3 What the Bot Puts in Your Group

Exactly two things ever appear in the group chat.

- The pinned announcement, with buttons **Join the Alumni Group** and **I'm Already In It**. It reposts every five days and drops the previous version, so only one copy is ever live.
- A follow-up message a few days later, naming who hasn't tapped either button.

Everything else happens in a private DM. Nobody is tagged in the group for not joining, and nobody is corrected in front of the team. Tell your members that.

4 What a Member Goes Through

Whether someone taps the button in their group or uses a one-time code, they land in a private chat with the bot and complete three steps:

- Complete the **Airtable form** (alumni database).
- Read the values document.
- Send a 50 to 100 word introduction.

Once done, they get a **one-time invite link to both the Alumni channel and the Alumni network chat**, and are admitted automatically.

I'm Already In It checks against the real group, so it can't be used to skip the process.

5 If Something Looks Wrong

Read once, or only when something looks wrong.

What You See	What's Happening
/gate_announce does nothing	Probably not a department lead , so it stays silent by design. If you are a lead, check the bot is a member but not yet Administrator.
Nothing happened at all	Step 3 hasn't run yet . Adding and promoting the bot alone leaves the group switched off, by design, not a fault.
It is not pinned	Bot has Administrator but not Pin Messages . The announcement still posts; it just doesn't stay pinned.

What You See	What's Happening
"But I am in the group!"	Almost always a second Telegram account. Confirm which account they use in the alumni group, then open the bot from that one.
"The bot will not reply to me"	They need to tap Start in the private chat once . Telegram blocks a bot from messaging anyone who hasn't done that first.
Anything else	Message @gapyearingdoesntsuck.

6 Commands for Department Leads

Department leads have three more commands, all used in a private chat with the bot.

- **/gate_stats**: who's in, mid-onboarding, or unengaged.
- **/gate_groups**: every group currently switched on.
- **/gate_unwatch**: switch a group back off.

Every one of these answers privately, even if you type it inside a group.